

KING PIGEON

Eka Pada Rajakapotasana

Pigeon pose, as practiced today, is not a traditional yoga asana. This modern kneeling backbend can be modified to offer therapeutic benefits for sciatica and back pain, with suitable options for everyone. Make sure you are warmed up and move slowly into this pose.

THE BIG PICTURE

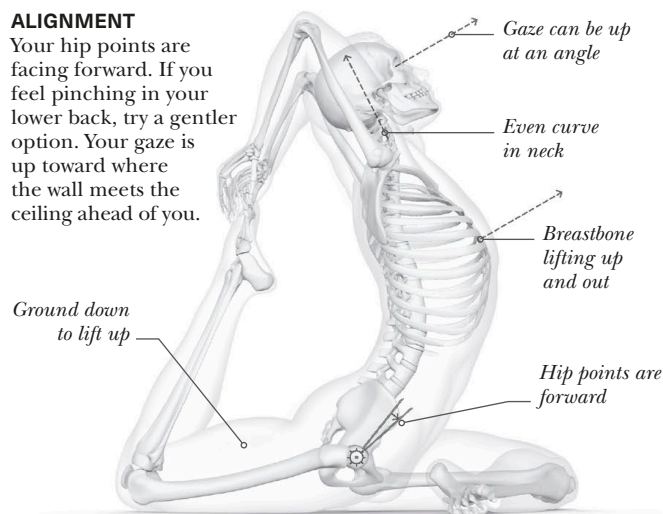
This version of the pose deeply stretches your hips, buttocks, thighs, abdomen, chest, and shoulders. Muscles in your arms, back, and hips engage to hold you in the pose, preventing you from toppling over.

KEY

- Joints
- Muscles
- Engaging
- Engaging while stretching
- Stretching

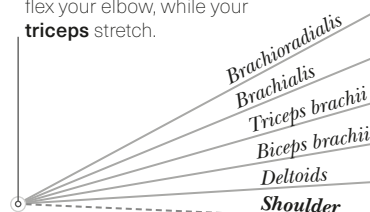
ALIGNMENT

Your hip points are facing forward. If you feel pinching in your lower back, try a gentler option. Your gaze is up toward where the wall meets the ceiling ahead of you.



Arms

Your **shoulder flexors** engage. Your **deltoids** dynamically engage to bring you into the position and then help pull your leg in. Your **brachialis**, **biceps**, and **brachioradialis** engage to flex your elbow, while your **triceps** stretch.



Back thigh

Your **hip extensors** are working to extend your hip, while your **quadriceps** maintain knee extension. Your **hip flexors** stretch strongly.

